

KORE.AI COMPETITIVE INTELLIGENCE

Competitive Signal Report

Topic: Enterprise agentic AI & contact-center AI (CCAI) · Window: last 72h · Sunday, 16 August 2026 · 20:19 IST
Prepared by Kore.ai Competitive Intelligence

Bottom line: Competitors like Five9 are pushing AI voice capabilities, but their underlying business models and product maturity present clear openings for Kore.ai's proven, omnichannel, and deterministic platform. IBM's strategic partnership with OpenAI signals a broader trend of leveraging large language models for enterprise AI, an area where Kore.ai's ABL provides a distinct advantage in control and predictability. Decagon's continued focus on open-source models highlights a segment of the market prioritizing flexibility, which can be contrasted with Kore.ai's enterprise-grade governance and reliability.

WHAT MATTERS THIS RUN

Three signals that matter

Five9 Integrates Voice AI Agents, Highlighting Model Limitations

WHAT HAPPENED

Regal Partners With Five9 to Bring AI Voice to Contact Centers [martechcube.com](#) (2026-08-14) [WHAT IT MEANS FOR KORE.AI](#)

While Five9 is adding voice AI, their core business remains seat-based, and AI integration often feels like an add-on, creating potential for cost overruns and less predictable TCO. Kore.ai's platform offers true omnichannel integration and a deterministic, outcome-based pricing model that contrasts sharply with the potential for hidden costs in seat-plus-consumption models.

IBM and OpenAI Deepen Enterprise AI Integration

WHAT HAPPENED

IBM and OpenAI team up to bring AI deeper into the enterprise [IBM](#) (2026-08-14) [WHAT IT MEANS FOR KORE.AI](#)
This partnership underscores the market trend towards leveraging powerful LLMs for enterprise AI. Kore.ai's Agent Behavior Language (ABL) provides a critical layer of control, determinism, and governance over these models, ensuring predictable and auditable outcomes that are essential for enterprise CX, a key differentiator against more open-ended LLM integrations.

Decagon Leverages Open-Source Models for Agent Operations

WHAT HAPPENED

Decagon runs 90% of its agents on open-source models [Dealroom](#) (2026-08-14) [WHAT IT MEANS FOR KORE.AI](#)
While open-source offers flexibility, it often comes with governance and reliability challenges for enterprise-grade CX. Kore.ai's platform-agnostic approach to model selection, combined with its robust ABL for deterministic execution and enterprise-grade governance, positions us as the superior choice for regulated industries and mission-critical CX applications where predictability and auditability are paramount.

AT A GLANCE

Signal priority table

Competitor	Move (dated)	Threat	Kore.ai counter
Five9	(2026-08-14) Regal Partners With Five9 to Bring AI Voice to Contact Centers - martechcube.com	Med	Deterministic omnichannel vs. seat-based model
IBM Agent Platform	(2026-08-14) IBM and OpenAI team up to bring AI deeper into the enterprise - IBM	Med	ABL for controlled LLM integration vs. open-ended LLM use
Decagon	(2026-08-14) Decagon runs 90% of its agents on open-source models - Dealroom	Low	Enterprise-grade governance vs. open-source flexibility
Sierra	(2026-08-13) StoreEase Partners With Sierra to Improve EaseOS AI Platform for Self-Storage Operators - Inside Self-Storage	Low	Proven analyst leadership vs. emerging platform

ON THE RADAR

Watch for

- Continued integration of voice AI by CCaaS players, and how they address cost and determinism.
- Further partnerships between large tech companies and LLM providers, and how they position their enterprise AI offerings.
- Decagon's ability to scale its open-source model strategy into enterprise-grade governance and compliance.

SO WHAT — DO THIS NOW

Recommended actions

- Emphasize Kore.ai's ABL as the key differentiator for controlled, deterministic, and auditable AI agent behavior, especially when competitors leverage open-ended LLMs.
- Highlight Kore.ai's true omnichannel capabilities and cost-predictability against the backdrop of seat-based models with consumption-based AI add-ons.
- Reinforce Kore.ai's leadership in analyst evaluations for Conversational AI for Customer Service, contrasting with competitors who may lead in adjacent categories but lack specific CX validation.
- Arm sales teams with talking points that contrast the "AI bolt-on" approach of CCaaS incumbents with Kore.ai's integrated, AI-native platform.

EVIDENCE TRAIL

Sources

- (2026-08-14) Regal Partners With Five9 to Bring AI Voice to Contact Centers - [martechcube.com](#)

- (2026-08-14) IBM and OpenAI team up to bring AI deeper into the enterprise - [IBM](#)
- (2026-08-14) Decagon runs 90% of its agents on open-source models - [Dealroom](#)
- (2026-08-13) StoreEase Partners With Sierra to Improve EaseOS AI Platform for Self-Storage Operators - [Inside Self-Storage](#)